ST. CECILIA'S COLLEGE – CEBU INC.

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WEB-BASED THESIS ARCHIVING: A TAILORED SYSTEM FOR ST. CECILIA'S COLLEGE – CEBU, IN., MINGLANILLA, CEBU.

(POLICY)

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I. Introduction

The Web-Based Thesis Archiving System is developed to support the institution in preserving, organizing, and managing student research outputs through a centralized digital platform. The system serves as a secure repository where approved theses are stored digitally as backup copies of official hardbound submissions. It enhances accessibility and improves document management by allowing authorized users to access research materials efficiently. This digital solution strengthens the institution's existing archiving process while maintaining academic record integrity.

Currently, the institution relies primarily on physical hardbound copies as the official record of submitted theses. However, physical documents are vulnerable to damage, loss, and limited accessibility when multiple users need to review them. To address these challenges, the system provides a controlled environment where thesis documents can be uploaded, reviewed, approved, and archived digitally. Although the system improves efficiency, it does not replace the requirement for hardbound submission but serves as a secure digital backup.

The Web-Based Thesis Archiving System Policy serves as a guide for managing, storing, and protecting academic theses within the system. It outlines the standards for submission, access, data handling, and proper use of the platform to ensure that all research outputs are preserved, organized, and easily accessible to authorized users. This policy also sets clear expectations on how the system should be used responsibly while maintaining the security and confidentiality of stored information, in line with applicable regulations such as the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (RA 10173).

II. Project Context

This policy is established to govern and support the implementation and operation of the Web-Based Thesis Archiving System within the institution. The system is introduced to address existing limitations associated with the management of physical thesis documents, including restricted accessibility, risk of loss or deterioration, and inefficiencies in storage and retrieval processes. It provides a structured and standardized approach to managing academic research outputs in a secure and centralized environment.

The Web-Based Thesis Archiving System shall serve as the institution's official digital repository for approved thesis documents. It provides a centralized platform that facilitates the submission, review, approval, storage, and retrieval of academic research in digital form. Access to the system shall be limited to duly authorized users, including students, faculty advisers, research coordinators, and administrative personnel, in accordance with defined roles and permissions.

Only theses that have satisfied all institutional requirements shall be eligible for inclusion in the system. Such requirements include formal approval by authorized academic personnel and the submission of required hardbound copies, where applicable. The system shall enforce compliance with these requirements to ensure the authenticity, accuracy, and integrity of all archived documents.

Core System Functions

The system shall include, but not be limited to, the following functionalities:

- Digital submission of thesis documents by authorized users
- Review and approval management by designated personnel
- Secure digital archiving of approved thesis documents
- Search and retrieval capabilities for academic and institutional reference
- Role-based access control for the regulation of user permissions
- Activity logging for monitoring and audit purposes

III. Agreement Between the Developer and the Client

The development and implementation of the system require coordination between the developer and the institution. Both parties share defined responsibilities to ensure proper system deployment and maintenance.

3.1 Responsibilities of the Developer

The developer shall:

- Design and develop the system based on approved requirements.
- Implement core functions including submission, approval, archiving, and
- retrieval.
- Integrate authentication and access control mechanisms.
- Conduct system testing before deployment.
- Provide system documentation and technical support during implementation.
- Assist in system configuration and initial setup.

3.2 Responsibilities of the Client (Institution)

The institution shall:

- Assign authorized personnel to manage system access and user accounts.
- Ensure that only approved and hardbound-submitted theses are uploaded.
- Monitor system usage and enforce policy compliance.
- Maintain required infrastructure such as servers and storage.
- Provide proper training for authorized users.

3.3 SIGNATORIES

This agreement is hereby acknowledged and approved by the following parties:

For the Developer:

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

For the Institution (Client):

Name: _____

Position: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Witnessed by:

Name: _____

Position: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

IV. Scope of the Security Control Policies

These security control policies apply to all individuals who access or manage the Web-Based Thesis Archiving System.

- This includes:
- Students
- Faculty members
- Research coordinators
- Administrators
- IT personnel the policies aim to:
- Protect thesis documents from unauthorized access
- Regulate system usage
- Ensure secure submission and approval processes
- Maintain data integrity and availability
- Support long-term academic preservation

V. System Operational Policies

5.1 User Registration Policy Purpose:

Purpose:

This policy ensures that only authorized and verified individuals are permitted to create and maintain accounts within the system, thereby maintaining the integrity, security, and reliability of user data.

Policy Guidelines:

- All users are required to complete the official registration form before being granted access to the system's features and services.
- Users must provide accurate, complete, and truthful information during registration. The system strictly prohibits the use of false, misleading, or incomplete data.

- Registration shall be limited exclusively to individuals who are officially affiliated with the institution (e.g., students, faculty, staff, or authorized personnel).
- All submitted registration forms are subject to review and approval by the system administrator or authorized personnel.
- User accounts shall remain inactive until they have been successfully verified and activated by the administrator.
- The administrator reserves the right to reject or deny registration requests that do not comply with institutional requirements or system policies.

5.2 User Account Management Policy

Purpose:

This policy defines the proper management, monitoring, and maintenance of user accounts to ensure system security, accountability, and proper usage.

Policy Guidelines:

- Each user is allowed to create and maintain only one (1) active account within the system. Multiple account creation is strictly prohibited.
- Users are responsible for keeping their account information up to date, including any changes to personal or institutional details.
- User account information may be modified upon request or as deemed necessary, subject to verification and approval by the system administrator.
- Accounts that remain inactive for an extended period may be reviewed and subject to temporary deactivation or archival by the system administrator.
- The system administrator reserves the right to suspend, restrict, or permanently disable accounts found to be in violation of system rules, misuse policies, or institutional regulations.
- Users are responsible for all activities conducted under their accounts and must ensure the confidentiality of their login credentials.

5.3 Password Security Policy

Purpose:

This policy is established to ensure the protection of user accounts and to prevent unauthorized access to the system by enforcing secure password practices.

Policy Guidelines:

- Users are required to create strong and secure passwords that consist of a combination of uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and special characters. Passwords must meet the system's minimum-security requirements.

- Passwords are strictly confidential and must not be shared, disclosed, or written in easily accessible locations.

- Users are fully responsible for safeguarding their credentials.

- Users are strongly advised to change their passwords immediately if there is any suspicion or indication of unauthorized access or compromised account security.

- Regular password updates may be encouraged or required by the system to enhance security and reduce potential risks.

- System administrators are authorized to reset user passwords, when necessary, particularly in cases of account recovery, security breaches, or system maintenance.

- All password reset actions performed by administrators shall follow proper verification procedures to ensure that account ownership is validated before access is restored.

5.4 Thesis Submission Policy

Purpose:

This policy establishes the standardized procedure for the digital submission of thesis documents through the Web-Based Thesis Archiving and Management System. It ensures proper documentation, accessibility, and compliance with institutional requirements, including the mandatory submission of hardbound copies.

Policy Guidelines:

- Students are required to submit an approved and finalized thesis through the system for digital archiving and institutional review purposes.
- Only theses that have successfully passed all academic requirements, including defense and final evaluation, shall be eligible for digital submission.
- All uploaded thesis documents must represent the complete and final version, including all required chapters, sections, revisions, and corrections as approved by the panel.
- Digital submissions must strictly comply with the institution's prescribed formatting standards, documentation guidelines, and file requirements.
- The submission of a digital copy through the system does not replace or waive the requirement for printed hardbound thesis copies mandated by the institution.
- Students are still required to submit the prescribed number of hardbound copies to the appropriate office for official recording and archival purposes.
- The digital version submitted through the system shall serve as an electronic archive and reference copy, accessible only to authorized users such as faculty members, research coordinators, and administrators.
- All submitted theses shall be subject to review and approval by research coordinators or designated authorized personnel before being officially included in the digital repository.
- The system administrator reserves the right to reject submissions that are incomplete, improperly formatted, or not aligned with institutional requirements.

5.5 Thesis Approval Policy

Purpose:

This policy ensures that only verified, complete, and compliant thesis documents are officially approved and included in the system archive.

Policy Guidelines:

- All thesis submissions must undergo thorough review and evaluation prior to approval and archiving.
- Only authorized personnel, such as research coordinators, faculty members, or designated administrators, are permitted to approve thesis submissions.
- Thesis documents that meet all institutional requirements, including formatting, completeness, and academic approval, shall be marked as approved and stored in the system's official digital archive.
- Submissions that do not meet the required standards shall be marked as rejected and returned to the student for revision and correction.
- Rejected theses must be revised and resubmitted through the system for further evaluation and approval.
- The approval process ensures the integrity, accuracy, and quality of all archived academic works.

5.6 Access Control Policy

Purpose:

This policy defines and regulates user access to system functionalities and thesis documents to ensure proper security, role-based access, and data protection.

Policy Guidelines:

- System access shall be granted strictly based on assigned user roles, such as student, faculty, coordinator, and administrator.
- Students are permitted to submit thesis documents and view only their own submissions and submission status.

- Faculty members, research coordinators, and administrators are authorized to review, manage, approve, and maintain thesis records within their designated responsibilities.

- Access to sensitive functions, including approval, deletion, and system configuration, shall be restricted to authorized personnel only.

- Unauthorized access to restricted features, records, or administrative functions is strictly prohibited and may result in disciplinary action or account suspension.

- The system shall enforce authentication and authorization mechanisms to ensure secure and controlled access at all times.

5.7 Data Privacy and Confidentiality Policy

Purpose:

This policy ensures the protection of user data and academic documents by maintaining confidentiality, integrity, and responsible handling of all stored information.

Policy Guidelines:

- All personal information collected from users during registration and system use shall be securely stored and protected against unauthorized access, alteration, or disclosure

- Thesis documents and related academic files shall remain confidential and must not be copied, shared, distributed, or published without proper authorization from the rightful owner and institutional approval.

- Users are required to respect and maintain the confidentiality of all academic works stored within the system.

- Access to personal data and thesis files shall be limited only to authorized users based on their roles and system permissions.

- The system shall implement appropriate security measures to safeguard data privacy and prevent unauthorized access or data breaches.

- Any violation of data privacy or confidentiality policies may result in disciplinary action, account suspension, or other sanctions as determined by the institution.

5.8 Filing Policy

Purpose:

This policy ensures that all thesis documents are systematically organized, properly categorized, and securely stored within the Thesis Archiving System to support efficient retrieval, management, and long-term preservation.

Policy Guidelines:

- All submitted thesis documents shall be stored within the system using a structured and standardized digital filing system.
- Each thesis record must include complete and accurate metadata, such as student name, student ID, department, program, year level, thesis title, and date of submission.
- The system shall automatically or manually organize thesis records based on their metadata to facilitate efficient searching, filtering, and retrieval.
- The system shall support two (2) types of thesis file submissions: a working document for review and revision, and a final version intended for permanent archiving.
- The working or revision copy of the thesis may be submitted in DOC or DOCX format to allow editing, feedback, and correction.
- Once all revisions have been completed and officially approved, the final version of the thesis must be submitted in PDF format for archiving purposes.
- Only the approved final PDF version shall be recognized as the official archived document within the system.
- Only authorized personnel are permitted to modify, update, or manage thesis metadata and filing information.
- All thesis records must be securely maintained to prevent data loss, duplication, corruption, or unauthorized modification.

5.9 Archiving Policy

Purpose:

This policy ensures the proper preservation and long-term storage of approved thesis documents within the system archive for academic reference and institutional record-keeping.

Policy Guidelines:

- The system archive shall serve as the central and official repository for all approved thesis documents.
- Only thesis submissions that have successfully undergone review and received official approval shall be eligible for permanent archiving.
- Each archived thesis shall include both the complete document and its corresponding metadata for proper identification and retrieval.
- Archived thesis documents shall be systematically organized to support efficient searching, indexing, and access by authorized users.
- Once a thesis is archived, it shall be preserved in its original approved form to ensure integrity, authenticity, and long-term availability.
- Any updates or modifications to archived records shall only be performed by authorized personnel under strict administrative control.

5.10 Backup Policy

Purpose:

This policy ensures the protection and recovery of all thesis documents and system data by implementing regular and secure backup procedures to prevent data loss or system failure.

Policy Guidelines:

- The system shall perform regular and scheduled backups of all thesis documents, metadata, and related system data stored in the archive.
- Backup copies shall be securely stored in a separate and protected storage location distinct from the main system database.

- Backups shall include both thesis files and their associated metadata to ensure complete restoration capability in case of system failure or data loss.

- Only authorized system administrators shall have access to, and control over, backup data and restoration processes.
- Backup data shall be periodically verified to ensure integrity, accuracy, and reliability for recovery purposes.

- The system shall maintain backup procedures that allow full restoration of data in the event of corruption, accidental deletion, or technical failure.

VI. Security Control Policies

6.1 Preventive Control Policy

Preventive controls are implemented to reduce risks and prevent security incidents before they occur within the system.

Policy Guidelines:

- All users must undergo authentication using valid and registered credentials prior to accessing system functionalities.

- User roles, permissions, and access levels shall be assigned strictly based on job functions, responsibilities, and institutional designation.

- Only authorized users are permitted to upload, submit, review, or approve thesis documents within the system.

- All uploaded files must comply with the institution's established formatting, documentation, and submission requirements.

- Users are responsible for maintaining the confidentiality and security of their login credentials and must not share account access with others.

6.2 Detective Control Policy

Detective controls are implemented to identify and monitor unauthorized, suspicious, or unusual activities within the system.

Policy Guidelines:

- The system shall automatically record user activities, including logins, uploads, downloads, approvals, and other relevant transactions.
- System logs shall be regularly reviewed and audited by authorized administrators to ensure compliance and detect anomalies.
- Any suspicious login attempts, unauthorized access, or abnormal system behavior shall be immediately investigated.
- Audit logs shall be securely stored and protected from unauthorized modification or deletion.

6.3 Corrective Control Policy

Corrective controls are implemented to address and resolve security issues after they have been identified or detected.

Policy Guidelines:

- All reported system incidents shall be properly documented and investigated by authorized system administrators.
- Unauthorized, corrupted, or incorrect thesis submissions shall be corrected, restricted, or removed as necessary.
- User accounts found in violation of system policies may be temporarily suspended or restricted pending investigation.
- Technical issues, system errors, and operational failures shall be resolved promptly to restore normal system functionality.

6.4 Recovery Control Policy

Recovery controls ensure that system data and services can be restored in the event of data loss, corruption, or system failure.

Policy Guidelines:

- The system shall maintain regular and updated backup copies of all thesis files, metadata, and related system data.
- Backup data shall be securely stored in a separate and protected location from the primary system database.
- Recovery procedures shall be established and implemented to restore system functionality in cases of failure, corruption, or accidental deletion.
- Only authorized system administrators shall perform data restoration processes.
- Recovery operations shall prioritize data integrity, accuracy, and completeness.

6.5 Deterrent Control Policy

Deterrent controls are implemented to discourage misuse, abuse, or unauthorized activity within the system.

Policy Guidelines:

- Users shall be informed that all system activities are monitored and recorded for security and auditing purposes.
- The system may display warnings or notifications regarding acceptable use and policy compliance.
- Any violation of system rules may result in disciplinary actions in accordance with institutional regulations.
- The presence of monitoring and enforcement mechanisms serves as a preventive measure against misuse.

6.6 Directive Control Policy

Directive controls provide clear instructions and guidelines to ensure proper and standardized system usage.

Policy Guidelines:

- Users must strictly follow the official procedures for digital thesis submission and system utilization.
- Only approved and verified thesis documents shall be eligible for archiving within the system.
- Access to thesis records and system functionalities must comply with assigned user roles and permissions.
- Users are expected to adhere to all institutional policies, guidelines, and system instructions at all times.

6.7 Administrative Control Policy

Administrative controls define the governance structure, responsibilities, and management of system operations.

Policy Guidelines:

- Authorized administrators are responsible for managing user accounts, roles, permissions, and system access rights.
- System access levels shall be assigned in accordance with clearly defined user roles and institutional hierarchy.
- Thesis review and approval processes must be performed only by designated and authorized personnel.
- All system procedures, updates, and policy changes shall be formally communicated to all users.
- Administrative oversight shall ensure the proper and secure operation of the system at all times.

6.8 Technical Control Policy

Technical controls are implemented to protect the system infrastructure, data, and digital assets from unauthorized access and technical threats.

Policy Guidelines:

- The system shall implement secure authentication mechanisms, including username and password validation.
- Role-based access control (RBAC) shall be enforced to restrict unauthorized access to system functions and files.
- All thesis documents and related data shall be securely stored within a protected database or server environment.
- Regular system updates, security patches, and maintenance procedures shall be conducted to ensure system integrity and security.
- Encryption and other security measures may be applied to protect sensitive data where applicable.

6.9 Physical Control Policy

Physical controls are implemented to protect hardware, infrastructure, and physical components supporting the system.

Policy Guidelines:

- All servers, storage devices, and system hardware shall be maintained in secure and restricted-access locations.
- Only authorized personnel shall be permitted to access or handle system infrastructure and equipment.
- Institutional devices used for system operation must be properly maintained, secured, and protected against damage or unauthorized use.
- Physical security measures shall be enforced to prevent theft, tampering, or unauthorized physical access.

VII. Policy Compliance and Monitoring

The institution shall implement continuous monitoring and evaluation to ensure strict compliance with all established system security policies.

Monitoring Activities Include:

- Regular review and auditing of system activity logs.
- Verification of thesis submission, review, and approval records.
- Monitoring of user access patterns and behavioral activity within the system.
- Periodic evaluation and updating of policies to ensure effectiveness and relevance.

These activities ensure accountability, transparency, and sustained system security.

VIII. Policy Enforcement Procedures

Non-compliance with established policies shall result in appropriate disciplinary and administrative actions in accordance with institutional rules and regulations.

Enforcement Measures May Include:

- Issuance of formal written warnings.
- Temporary suspension of system access privileges.
- Restriction, modification, or revocation of user account permissions.
- Escalation of violations to appropriate institutional authorities for further action.

All enforcement actions shall be implemented fairly, consistently, and in accordance with due process.

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